

Preserving the Past in a Changing World – Adi Levy

In our world today, the dilemma of what is more important - tradition verses progression, comes up a lot. Especially when it comes to old buildings and historical landmarks.

Although preserving traditional landmarks can be significant and important, I think that it is more important to stay up to date with the needs of the people and know when it is more valuable to encourage modern development.

When cities prioritize preserving historic buildings over modern development it can lead to many problems that might not be obvious at first. For example, lack of affordable housing, which can lead to high homelessness rates, that can cause cities to crash economically and socially. We can see that a lot with big cities like Los Angeles or San Francisco, when you are not able to walk one mile without encountering somebody sleeping on the streets. If the cities had invested more in developing more affordable housing, rather than preserving old buildings, maybe the situation would have been different. While preserving ancient landmarks might sound nice in theory, when it comes to real world scenario, I believe that people's wellbeing should come before preservation of tradition.

Preserving old buildings might also be problematic sometimes when it comes to the environment and public safety in general. In the past few years, we have been making a lot of progress in preserving the environment. So, while in new developments, we can find a way to improve in this aspect, if we want to preserve old buildings, they will usually operate in much more traditional and old systems, that often can have hazardous constructions or polluting systems. All that shows us how sometimes it is better to invest more in new developments rather than stay stuck in the past, to improve people's quality of life and wellbeing.

That said, I do believe that nothing is absolute. Sometimes preserving old buildings and landmarks could have a significant value. Some cities and cultures hold more value to their tradition, that is expressed through their landmarks, than to creating new developments. And sometimes it also has an economic advantage as preserving ancient landmarks can attract tourism. But in most cases that is not a realistic way of existing in the long run.

Society only moves forward, not backward. Every day there are more babies being born who are going to need housing soon. So, it might not be such a pressing issue in some places. But I do believe that as a society, we should always encourage new development over preserving old building so that when the time comes, and it is needed for maintaining people's quality of life – there is not doubt what decision should be made.

In conclusion, I think that encouraging new developments is more important than preserving historic buildings. Although preserving buildings can have significant cultural importance, sometimes it does not align with what the community needs right now. To maintain people's quality of life, we need to encourage progression and development, over preservation of historic buildings.